

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> Assessing the symptoms described by the patient, we must carefully consider the potential mental health conditions that could be present. The patient reports feelings of hopelessness, suicidal ideations, and difficulty making decisions, which suggest a significant level of emotional distress. The combination of these symptoms suggests that the patient's mental health may be at risk. Let's examine the answer choices to identify the most appropriate description of the patient's condition. </think><answer> A. The patient is at risk for double depression. </answer>

